

PERSUASIVE WRITING

Structure and Organisation

A well-structured persuasive text presents a clear position, supports it with strong reasons and evidence, and ends with a powerful call to action.



THE PERSUASIVE STRUCTURE



1 INTRODUCTION – STATE YOUR POSITION

Grab the reader's attention, introduce the topic and clearly state your position.

- Start with a hook (question, fact, quote or anecdote)
- Briefly introduce the issue
- Clearly state your opinion (thesis statement)

EXAMPLE:

Every teenager knows the struggle of early mornings. It's time our school starts later.



2 REASONS – SUPPORT YOUR POSITION

Present your main reasons for your position.

- Use topic sentences to introduce each reason
- Explain your reasons clearly
- Keep each reason focused and relevant

EXAMPLE:

Firstly, teenagers need more sleep to learn and focus better at school.



3 EVIDENCE – BACK IT UP

Support each reason with evidence and examples.

- Use facts, statistics, expert opinions or real-life examples
- Explain how your evidence supports your reason
- Make your argument strong and convincing

EXAMPLE:

Research shows that tired students struggle to learn and have lower grades.



4 ADDRESS THE OTHER SIDE

Acknowledge and refute opposing arguments.

- Show you understand the other side
- Explain why it is not as strong as your position
- Stay respectful and logical

EXAMPLE:

Some people say early starts build discipline, but this comes at the cost of our health and learning.



5 CONCLUSION – CALL TO ACTION

Summarise your position and encourage action.

- Revisit your main points
- Restate your position in a new way
- End with a strong call to action

EXAMPLE:

It's time for our school to put students' health first. Let's start later and learn better!

STAY ORGANISED!

Strong organisation helps your argument flow and keeps your reader engaged. Check your writing:



Clear Position

Is your opinion clear and easy to find?



Logical Order

Do your ideas follow a logical sequence?



Relevant Support

Does each reason connect to your position?



Strong Evidence

Is your evidence relevant, accurate and convincing?



Balanced View

Have you acknowledged and responded to other viewpoints?



Powerful Ending

Does your ending leave the reader inspired to act?

TIPS FOR GREAT ORGANISATION



PLAN FIRST

Brainstorm your ideas and plan your structure before you start writing.



USE PARAGRAPHS

One main idea per paragraph keeps your writing clear and focused.



USE TRANSITIONS

Words like *however*, *therefore*, *for example*, in addition help your writing flow smoothly.



CHECK YOUR WORK

Make sure each paragraph supports your argument and stays on topic.



KNOW YOUR AUDIENCE

Write in a way that connects with your readers and inspires them.

Remember:

Your goal is not just to inform, but to persuade. A strong structure helps your ideas make a bigger impact!



PERSUASIVE WRITING

Language Features

Persuasive writers use powerful language to influence the reader's thoughts, feelings and actions. Here are the key language features and how to use them.



1. EMOTIVE LANGUAGE

Words that appeal to the reader's feelings and create an emotional connection.

EXAMPLE:

"Every child deserves a safe, happy place to learn and grow."



2. STRONG, POWERFUL VERBS

Action verbs make your writing more forceful and convincing.

EXAMPLE:

"We must act now to protect our environment for future generations."



3. MODAL VERBS

Modal verbs show possibility, necessity, obligation or recommendation.

EXAMPLE:

"We should reduce plastic use because small changes can make a big difference."



4. RHETORICAL QUESTIONS

Questions asked to make the reader think – they don't need an answer, but they make a strong point.

EXAMPLE:

"Do we really want to keep ignoring a problem that affects all of us?"



5. FACTS AND STATISTICS

Using facts, numbers and data makes your argument credible and trustworthy.

EXAMPLE:

"Did you know that 8 million tonnes of plastic enters our oceans every year?"



6. TRIPLES (THE RULE OF THREE)

Listing three words, phrases or ideas is memorable and adds impact.

EXAMPLE:

"We need cleaner air, safer streets and better public transport."



7. INCLUSIVE LANGUAGE

Words like *we*, *our* and *together* involve the reader and create a sense of unity.

EXAMPLE:

"Together, we can build a brighter, healthier future for everyone."



8. COMMANDS AND IMPERATIVES

Direct, bossy language encourages the reader to take action.

EXAMPLE:

"Join the movement. Speak up. Make a difference today!"



9. EVIDENCE AND EXAMPLES

Real-life examples and evidence help support your argument and make it believable.

EXAMPLE:

"Schools that have recycling programs reduce waste by up to 30% each year."



10. HIGH MODALITY WORDS

Words like *always*, *never*, *every*, *all*, *none*, *definitely*, *absolutely* make your language stronger.

EXAMPLE:

"We must always protect our planet – there is no alternative."

ALWAYS
NEVER
EVERY
ALL
DEFINITELY
ABSOLUTELY

WHY THESE FEATURES MATTER



They connect with the reader's heart.



They make your ideas clear and memorable.



They build trust and credibility.



They persuade and inspire action.



They make your writing powerful!

WRITER'S TIP

Use a variety of these language features in your writing to make your argument stronger and your voice impossible to ignore!



PERSUASIVE WRITING

Annotated Exemplar

See how this persuasive text uses structure, language features and techniques to argue a position and persuade the reader.



We Need More Green Spaces in Our Cities

STRONG OPENING

Grabs the reader's attention and clearly introduces the topic and position.

Our cities are growing fast. With more buildings, roads and cars, we are losing something important—green spaces. Parks, gardens and trees aren't just nice to have; they are essential. It's time our leaders make more green spaces a top priority.

LANGUAGE FEATURES IN ACTION



EMOTIVE LANGUAGE

"essential", "it's time"
Appeals to the reader's feelings and sense of urgency.

REASON 1 – HEALTH BENEFITS

Uses facts and positive language to show why green spaces are important.

Firstly, green spaces are vital for our health. Studies show that spending time in nature reduces stress, improves mood and even helps us live longer. In a world where anxiety and mental health issues are rising, our parks and trees provide a natural, free and powerful solution.



POWERFUL VERBS

"reduces", "improves", "helps"
Makes the benefits feel real and impactful.

REASON 2 – ENVIRONMENTAL BENEFITS

Uses strong verbs and specific examples to explain the positive impact.

Secondly, green spaces help our environment. Trees clean the air by absorbing pollution and releasing oxygen. They also cool our cities on hot days, reduce flooding by soaking up rainwater, and provide homes for birds and insects. More green spaces mean a healthier planet for everyone.



FACTS AND EVIDENCE

"Studies show...", "research shows..."
Builds credibility and makes the argument trustworthy.

REASON 3 – COMMUNITY BENEFITS

Shows how green spaces improve people's lives and bring communities together.

In addition, green spaces bring communities together. Parks are places where people of all ages can play, exercise, relax and connect. They create safer, stronger neighbourhoods and give people a sense of belonging.



INCLUSIVE LANGUAGE

"our", "we", "everyone", "people of all ages"
Includes the reader and builds a sense of unity.

COUNTERARGUMENT + REFUTATION

Acknowledges the opposing view and uses evidence to refute it.

Some people say we don't have space or money for more parks. However, research shows that every dollar spent on green spaces saves money in the long run by improving health, reducing crime and lowering storm damage.



CONTRAST AND REFUTATION

"Some people say... However..."
Shows understanding of other views and strengthens the writer's position.

CONCLUSION – CALL TO ACTION

Summarises key points and ends with a strong call to action to inspire the reader.

Our city's future depends on the choices we make today. More green spaces mean better health, a cleaner environment and stronger communities. Let's invest in what truly matters.

Ask your local leaders to create more parks and protect our green spaces—because a greener city is a better city for all.
The time to act is now!



CALL TO ACTION

"Ask your local leaders to...", "The time to act is now!"
Encourages the reader to take action.

WHAT MAKES THIS EFFECTIVE?



CLEAR STRUCTURE

Follows a logical structure: introduction, reasons, refutation and conclusion.



STRONG IDEAS

Each reason is clear, relevant and supported.



CONVINCING EVIDENCE

Facts and examples add credibility and build trust.



ENGAGING LANGUAGE

Emotive words, strong verbs and inclusive phrases connect with the reader.



PURPOSEFUL ENDING

Leaves the reader inspired and motivated to act.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- ✓ State your position clearly.
- ✓ Support your ideas with reasons and evidence.
- ✓ Use powerful language to influence your reader.
- ✓ Acknowledge other views and refute them.
- ✓ End with a strong call to action.

